

Name: _____

Period: _____

Date: _____

Topic 0.1 Guided Notes: The Scientific Attitude

Unit 0: Science Practices | AP Psychology

Directions: Read through the topic overview page below and fill in each blank as you go. Use the tables and activities to check your understanding, then head to the quiz link at the end to test yourself.

Source page: appsychreviewhub.com/overviews/topic0.1

Word Bank

<i>Hindsight Bias</i>	<i>Evidence-Based</i>	<i>Overconfidence</i>
<i>Humility</i>	<i>Critical Thinking</i>	<i>Cultural Norms, Expectations, and Circumstances</i>
<i>Concept Application</i>	<i>Perceiving Order in Random Events</i>	<i>Curiosity</i>
<i>Psychology</i>	<i>Skepticism</i>	<i>Confirmation Bias</i>

1. More Than Just Common Sense

_____ is strictly defined as the scientific study of behavior and mental processes. Because it is a science, it requires a rigorous, _____ approach to evaluating claims — not just intuitive guesses about human nature.

2. The Elements of the Scientific Attitude

Fill in each pillar of the scientific attitude, then answer the key question each one asks.

- _____: a passion to explore and understand the world without misleading or being misled. Key questions: "Does it work?" and "_____?"
- _____: refusing to blindly accept arguments and conclusions — the balance between cynicism and gullibility. Key questions: "What do you mean?" and "_____?"
- _____: an awareness of our own vulnerability to error and an openness to surprises and new perspectives — being willing to admit when the data proves us wrong.

Curiosity, skepticism, and humility combine to feed _____ — a smarter style of thinking that examines assumptions, appraises the source, discerns hidden biases, evaluates evidence, and assesses conclusions.

3. The Flaws of Intuition (Cognitive Biases)

Fill in the name of each bias next to its description.

Description	Bias Name
Believing, after an outcome is known, that you could have predicted it all along ("I knew it all along")	

Description	Bias Name
Being more confident than correct — overestimating the accuracy of your own beliefs and judgments	
Searching for information that supports what you already believe, while ignoring evidence that contradicts it	
Perceiving meaningful patterns in random data, like seeing a face in a cloud or believing in a gambling "hot streak"	

Apply It: Identify the bias in each scenario

Using the word bank above, write which bias best explains each student's thinking.

#	Scenario	Bias
1	"Of course the marshmallow-test kids with more self-control did better later in life — that's just obvious."	
2	Maria only reads news articles that confirm her opinion on a topic and skips over the ones that don't.	
3	"I'm sure I'll get an A on the AP exam without studying — I always do well on tests like this."	
4	Jordan is convinced his lucky socks are why his team is on a winning streak.	

4. AP Science Practice Focus: Concept Application

The AP Exam tests more than definitions — it tests your ability to apply concepts to real scenarios. This is officially called _____. On the exam, you'll be given a short paragraph describing someone making a flawed judgment and asked to identify which specific cognitive bias is driving it.

This skill also requires you to explain how _____ shape behavior — recognizing that what looks unusual in one cultural context may be typical in another — and to explain the implications of applying a theory developed on one population to a very different group.

5. Don't Trip Up! (Common Misconceptions)

Circle the bias that matches each example, then explain the timing difference between the two in your own words.

"I don't need to study for Unit 1, I already know it all!" → Hindsight Bias / Overconfidence

Failing the Unit 1 test and thinking, "I knew I should have studied more, I saw that coming!" → Hindsight Bias / Overconfidence

In your own words, when does each one happen? Overconfidence happens _____ an event, while Hindsight Bias happens _____ an event.

6. Quick Check: Review Questions

Circle the best answer for each question below.

1. Before taking her first psychology exam, Priya says, "I don't even need to study, I already understand all of this perfectly." She then fails the exam. Priya's statement before the exam is best explained by:

- A. Hindsight Bias
- B. Humility
- C. Overconfidence
- D. Perceiving Order in Random Events

2. After a psychology study finds that sleep-deprived people perform worse on memory tests, a student remarks, "Well, obviously, everyone already knew that would happen." This student's reaction demonstrates:

- A. Confirmation Bias
- B. Curiosity
- C. Hindsight Bias
- D. Overconfidence

3. A political blogger only reads news sources that align with his existing views and dismisses any article that challenges his position as "fake news" without evaluating its evidence. This behavior best illustrates:

- A. Hindsight Bias
- B. Confirmation Bias
- C. Critical Thinking
- D. Overconfidence



Check Your Progress

Done with your notes? Head over to the [Unit 0 Quiz](https://appspsychreviewhub.com/quiz) to test what you've learned:

<https://appspsychreviewhub.com/quiz>

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